

Week 13 Logic Lab

TESTIMONY, AUTHORITY, AND CREDIBILITY

Purpose: Apply Week 13 skills to new source and credibility cases. Do not copy examples from the reading handout.

Part 1: Source, Claim, and Access

Question 1.1

A student newspaper reports, “The debate club will move to Wednesdays,” and cites the club adviser, who approves the calendar. Identify the claim, the source, and whether the source has access to know.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

A student who skipped the meeting says, “I heard the robotics team cancelled the regional trip.” Identify what the source can know directly and what would need a better source.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 1 Q2

Part 2: Expertise and Relevance

Question 2.1

A famous musician says a new phone is the most secure phone available. What authority does the musician have, and what expertise would be relevant to the security claim?

ANSWER LABEL: Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

A school nurse explains why several students should stay home during a fever outbreak. A student council president disagrees because attendance at events might drop. Compare the relevance of the two sources for the health question.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 2 Q2

Part 3: Bias and Corroboration

Question 3.1

A restaurant owner claims, “Our inspection score was excellent,” but the sign in the window shows only last year’s score. What bias or pressure may affect the claim, and what corroboration would help?

ANSWER LABEL: Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

Three students say the bus was late, but all three got the information from the same group chat message. Explain whether this is independent corroboration and what would make the report stronger.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 3 Q2

Part 4: Credibility Map in a Paragraph

Question 4.1

Read the paragraph. Make a credibility map: claim, source, access, expertise, possible bias, corroboration or conflict, and careful conclusion.

A city committee is deciding whether to keep a weekend shuttle. The shuttle company says ridership is “strong enough to expand,” but its report counts every boarding separately, so one rider who transfers twice is counted three times. A neighborhood association says the shuttle is “empty most of the time,” but its volunteers watched only one rainy Saturday morning. The city transit office has six months of fare-card data but has not yet released the full summary.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 4 Q1

Part 5: Review

Question 5.1

“Four students who used the new essay checklist improved on the next draft, so the checklist guarantees better writing for every student.” Name the examples, the overclaim, and a revised claim.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 5 Q1

Question 5.2

“A city budget is like a family budget: both must decide what matters most when money is limited. Therefore the council should publish priorities before voting.” Identify the source case, target case, and relevant similarity.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 5 Q2